Data-Driven Smartphone Selection: A Jumia Market Analysis

DESCRIPTION

This project is an extensive research involving Excel, SQL and Power BI, where the choice of a suitable smartphone of was made.

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PROJECT SCOPE

EVALUATION OF PROBLEM

A friend is asking for recommendations on a possible choice of phone. The key or core features that she's looking for in the phone are RAM (Phone processor) and ROM (Phone Memory). She has a budget of N300k – N450k to make the purchase. Also, she wants a brand that is common that the spare parts can be easily sourced in the case of phone damage and repair.

OBJECTIVE

The goal, aim or objective of this project is to get an idea on the details and prices of phones to enable her make a choice. So, she's looking to make a choice based on the;

- Phone Brand
- Phone RAM
- Phone ROM; and
- Phone price (N300k – N450k)

With these, this our analytical project will be answering the following key questions;

1. How many phone brands do we have from the listing?
2. Which are the top 5 brands with the most (common) listing?
3. What are the RAM ranges of the phones under the price category (N300k – N450k)?
4. What are the ROM ranges of the phones under the price category (N300k – N450k)?
5. Which phones give the best value for money in terms of Brand, ROM and RAM?

DATA IDENTIFICATION

DATA SOURCE

Since the purchase will be made from local stores in the country, we needed to a place where the prices of different phones are listed to give us an idea of what the prices might be. There are many sites that sell phone online, but for the safety, quality, accuracy and originality, we decided to use the most common or popular one, Jumia Online Stores. We will get the current phone listing from Jumia Official Website (www.jumia.com.ng).

DATA AVAILABILITY AND COMPLIANCE CHECKS

We extracted 400+ rows of phone listing, which had;

- Phone names
- Brand names
- Phone RAM
- Phone ROM
- Colour

- Network strength
- Battery strength
- Seller store
- Phone initial price
- Discount
- Phone price after discount
- Rating reviews
- Normal rating
- Payment status
- Carts
- Promo status
- Store

What we need;

- ✓ Phone names
- ✓ Phone RAM
- ✓ Phone ROM
- ✓ Phone initial price
- ✓ Phone price after discount

DATA EXTRACTION

DATA COLLECTION

1. We used Power Query to access the Jumia Official webpage to extract the data from the site.

POWER QUERY CODE

```
let
   Pages = List.Numbers(6, 25),
   Tables = List.Transform(Pages, each fnJumiaPage(_)),
   Combined = Table.Combine(Tables)
in
   Combined
```

DATA EPLORATION

Data exploration notes;

1. Contains 412 rows
2. Has 10 columns
3. Contains a lot of missing values in all columns except columns 1 & 2.
4. We will only be needing phone name, phone storage and processor (if available), phone price and company name. so other columns will be removed.
5. There was an OUKITEL Phone that has a 24GB RAM 256 ROM, yet, it was cheap. We investigated it and found out that it was a discount offer from one of the sellers.

DATA CLEANING NOTES

1. After exploring the already collected data with Excel, we pulled it into MySQL workbench for cleaning.
2. While the data was pulled in, we encountered several errors that prevented the data from being imported properly. We;
    a. Re-saved the file as 'CSV UTF 8' file.
    b. Changed the datatype of the columns to 'VARCHAR'.

   This allowed for smooth loading of the table.

3. We added the following columns;
    a) brand_name (represents the phone brand)
    b) phone_name (each phones name only) – trimmed to maximum of 30 characters.
    c) phone_ROM (each phone's ROM if available)
    d) phone_RAM (each phone's RAM if available)
    e) row_id (to make each row unique)
4. We have about 412 rows of phone listings from different stores (sellers). But during deduplication, we keep getting some listed as duplicates despite rating_reviews showing different ratings (pertaining to the seller). So, we decided to identify each row with a store name. Since the objective is to get the best phone as regards the Phone name, brand, price, RAM and ROM, we carried on despite the fact that different phones can be listed by the same seller or store.
   We used the following code:

5. We removed any row which any of these columns were not containing any value;

a) brand_name
b) phone_RAM
c) phone_ROM

6. The extracted columns and rows in the data were placed in an SQL view, known as view_cleaned_jumia_phones.

VALIDITY AND QAULITY CHECKS

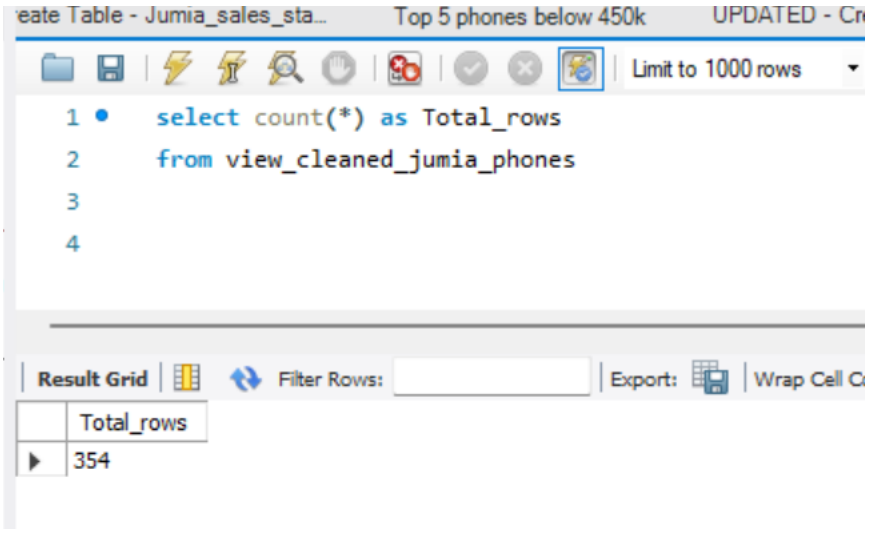
We need the following columns for our analysis;

1. row_id
2. brand_name
3. phone_name
4. phone_price
5. phone_ROM
6. phone_RAM

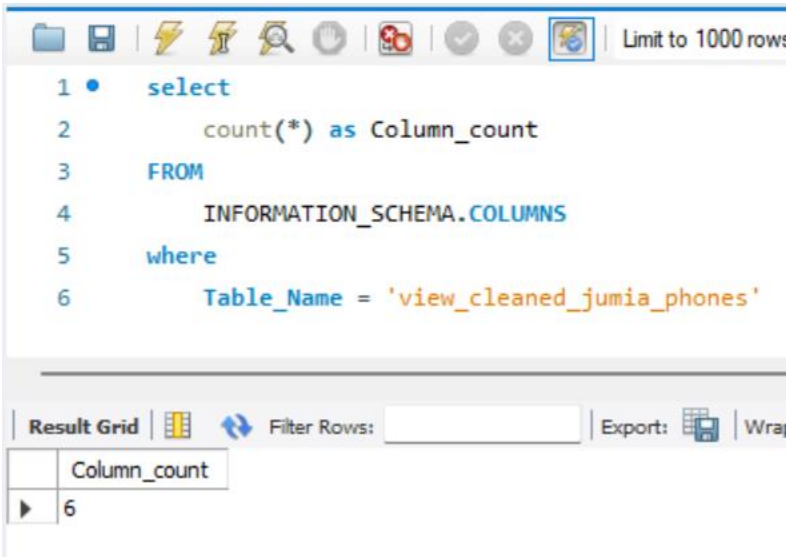
And they're all available.

We'll be performing the following validity and compliance checks;

ROW COUNT

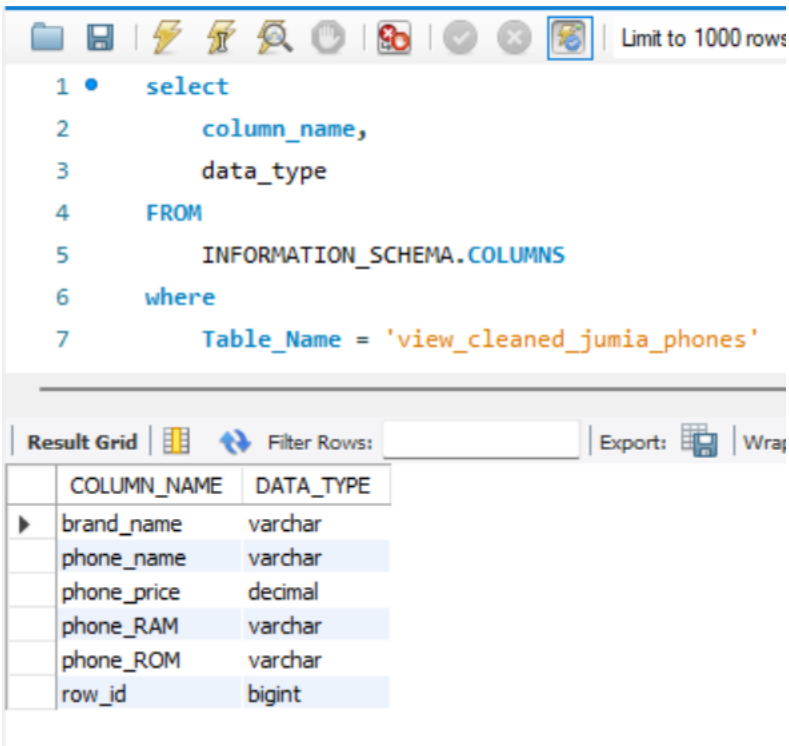


COLUMN COUNT



DATA TYPES CHECK

We had to change back the data type of the phone_price column back to decimal (10, 2) since it was in varchar when it was imported. This is to enable us carry out any (if need be) successful arithmetic queries on the dataset.

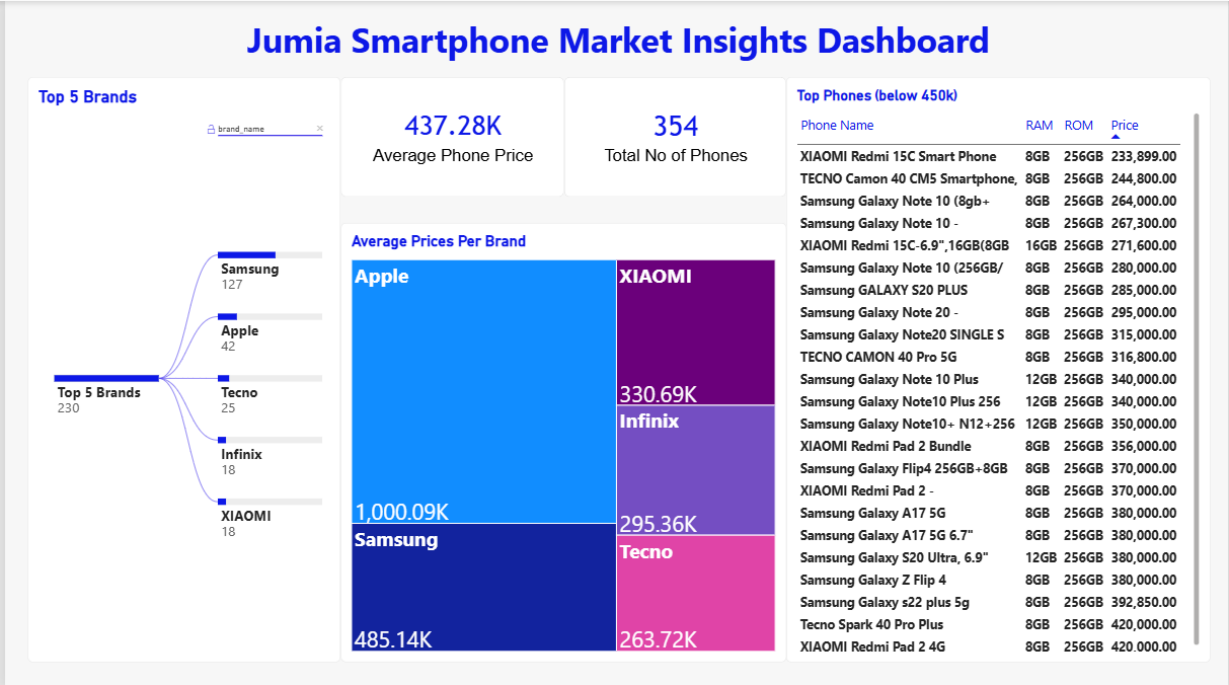


DUPLICATE CHECK

We ran a duplicate check on the main table (jumia_phone_staging) where we confirmed that we had listings from different sellers. We added a tag to represent each unique poster/seller.

VISUALIZATION

RESULTS



DAX MEASURES

Average Phone Price

```
Avg Phone Price =
VAR TotalphonePrice = SUM('jumia_sales cleaned_jumia_phones'[phone_price])
VAR Total_No_of_Phones = COUNT('jumia_sales cleaned_jumia_phones'[phone_price])
VAR AvgPhonePrice =
    DIVIDE (TotalphonePrice, Total_No_of_Phones)
RETURN
    AvgPhonePrice
```

Total Sellers

```
Total_Sellers =
    VAR Total_Sellers = COUNT('jumia_sales cleaned_jumia_phones'[row_id])

RETURN
    Total_Sellers
```

ANALYSIS

EXPLORATORY DATA ANALYSIS

Findings

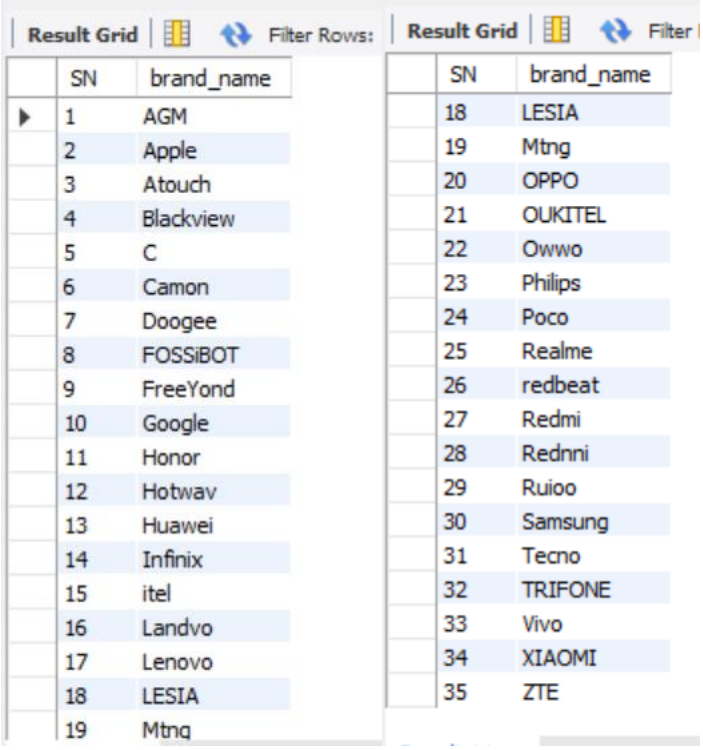
What did we find?

For this analysis, we need to focus on the following questions;

1. How many phone brands do we have from the listing?
2. Which are the top 5 brands with the most (common) listing?
3. What are the RAM ranges of the phones under the price category (N300k – N450k)?
4. What are the ROM ranges of the phones under the price category (N300k – N450k)?
5. Which phones give the best value for money in terms of Brand, ROM and RAM?

From our Dataset, we have;

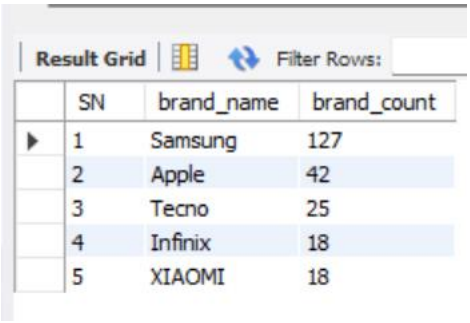
1. Phones brands listed
   We have about 35 different Phone brands in the phone listing



SN	brand_name
1	AGM
2	Apple
3	Atouch
4	Blackview
5	C
6	Camon
7	Doogee
8	FOSSiBOT
9	FreeYond
10	Google
11	Honor
12	Hotwav
13	Huawei
14	Infinix
15	itel
16	Landvo
17	Lenovo
18	LESIA
19	Mtng

SN	brand_name
18	LESIA
19	Mtng
20	OPPO
21	OUKITEL
22	Owwo
23	Philips
24	Poco
25	Realme
26	redbeat
27	Redmi
28	Rednni
29	Ruioo
30	Samsung
31	Tecno
32	TRIFONE
33	Vivo
34	XIAOMI
35	ZTE

2. Top 5 brands in the listing



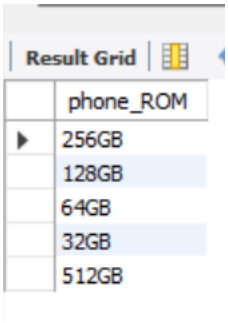
SN	brand_name	brand_count
1	Samsung	127
2	Apple	42
3	Tecno	25
4	Infinix	18
5	XIAOMI	18

3. Phone RAM in the category (less than or equal to 450k)



phone_RAM
8GB
2GB
4GB
3GB
6GB
32GB
12GB
16GB
24GB
5gb

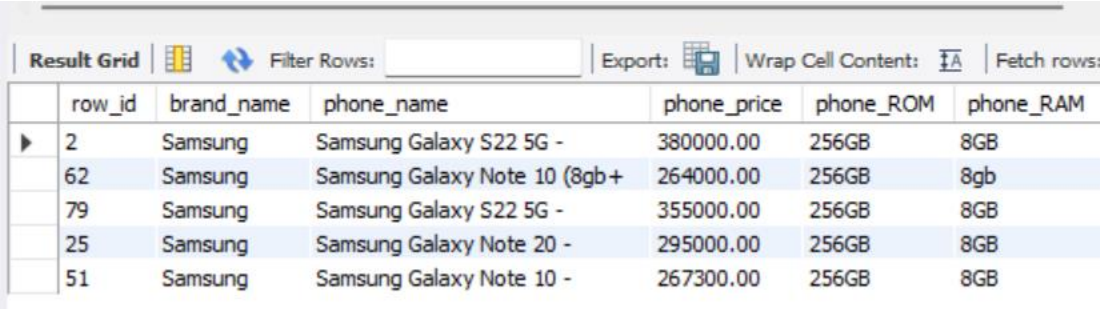
4. Phone ROM in the category (less than or equal to 450k)



phone_ROM
256GB
128GB
64GB
32GB
512GB

5. Phones with the best value for money in terms of Brand, ROM and RAM. To investigate this, we will look into the following;
    i. Only phones from the Top 5 brands will be considered.
        - Samsung
        - Apple
        - Tecno
        - Infinix
        - Xiaomi
    ii. Given the availability of higher ROMs, it won't be financially wise to look into lower ones such as 64GB & 32GB. Therefore, we'll be focusing on 128GB, 256GB and 512GB.
    iii. Likewise, we won't be looking into RAMs within the range of 2-6 GB. Rather we'll focus on 8GB, 16GB and 24GB.

Top 5 Samsung phones (below N450k)



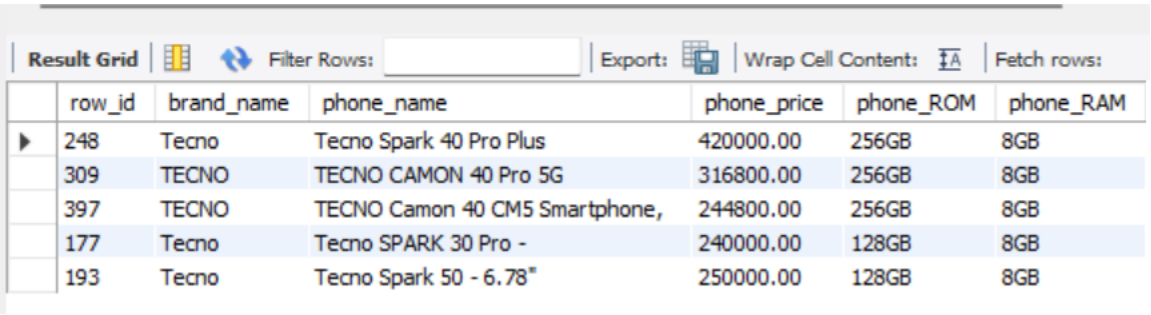
Result Grid | Filter Rows: | Export: | Wrap Cell Content: | Fetch rows:

row_id	brand_name	phone_name	phone_price	phone_ROM	phone_RAM
2	Samsung	Samsung Galaxy S22 5G -	380000.00	256GB	8GB
62	Samsung	Samsung Galaxy Note 10 (8gb+	264000.00	256GB	8gb
79	Samsung	Samsung Galaxy S22 5G -	355000.00	256GB	8GB
25	Samsung	Samsung Galaxy Note 20 -	295000.00	256GB	8GB
51	Samsung	Samsung Galaxy Note 10 -	267300.00	256GB	8GB

Top 5 Apple phones (below N450k)

There are no Apple phones below 450k phone RAMs of 8GB and higher, or phone ROMs of 128GB and higher.

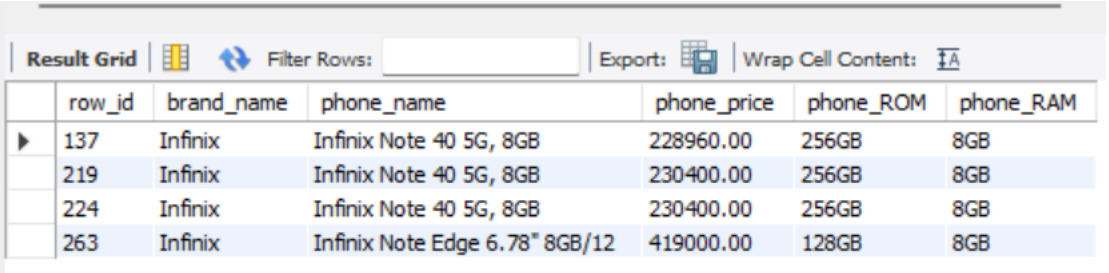
Top 5 Tecno phones (below N450k)



Result Grid | Filter Rows: | Export: | Wrap Cell Content: | Fetch rows:

row_id	brand_name	phone_name	phone_price	phone_ROM	phone_RAM
248	Tecno	Tecno Spark 40 Pro Plus	420000.00	256GB	8GB
309	TECNO	TECNO CAMON 40 Pro 5G	316800.00	256GB	8GB
397	TECNO	TECNO Camon 40 CM5 Smartphone,	244800.00	256GB	8GB
177	Tecno	Tecno SPARK 30 Pro -	240000.00	128GB	8GB
193	Tecno	Tecno Spark 50 - 6.78"	250000.00	128GB	8GB

Top 5 Infinix phones (below N450k)



Result Grid | Filter Rows: | Export: | Wrap Cell Content:

row_id	brand_name	phone_name	phone_price	phone_ROM	phone_RAM
137	Infinix	Infinix Note 40 5G, 8GB	228960.00	256GB	8GB
219	Infinix	Infinix Note 40 5G, 8GB	230400.00	256GB	8GB
224	Infinix	Infinix Note 40 5G, 8GB	230400.00	256GB	8GB
263	Infinix	Infinix Note Edge 6.78" 8GB/12	419000.00	128GB	8GB

Top 5 XIAOMI phones (below N450k)



Result Grid | Filter Rows: | Export: | Wrap Cell Content:

row_id	brand_name	phone_name	phone_price	phone_ROM	phone_RAM
173	XIAOMI	XIAOMI Redmi Pad 2 -	370000.00	256GB	8GB
242	XIAOMI	XIAOMI Redmi Pad 2 Bundle	356000.00	256GB	8GB
372	XIAOMI	XIAOMI Redmi Pad 2 4G	420000.00	256GB	8GB
411	XIAOMI	XIAOMI Redmi 15C Smart Phone	233899.00	256GB	8GB

Best value by brand

Phone Brand	Phone Name	Price (N)	Phone ROM	Phone RAM
SAMSUNG	Samsung Galaxy Note 10+	264,000	256GB	8GB
APPLE	null	null	null	null
TECNO	Tecno Camon 40 CM5	244,800	256GB	8GB
INFINIX	Infinix Note 40	229,920	256GB	8GB
XIAOMI	XIAOMI Redmi 15C	233,899	256GB	8GB

There were 3 different listings of Infinix Note 40, so we used the average of the 3 of them.

DISCOVERY

We discovered that;

- ✓ there are 35 unique phone brands listed
- ✓ the top 5 brands include; Samsung, Apple, Tecno, Infinix and XIAOMI.
- ✓ the maximum phone RAM across the Top 5 brands is 8GB.
- ✓ the maximum phone ROMs across the Top 5 brands are 128GB & 256GB.
- ✓ the cheapest

RECOMMENDATIONS

POTENTIAL COURSES OF ACTION

From our analysis, there are 4 possible recommendations:

FIRST CHOICE – Tecno Camon 40 CM5

Pros

- affordable
- common in the locale
- accessories are available and relatively cheap

Cons

- capacity limited
- might overheat subsequently
- decent battery strength and capacity
- possible phone lags

SECOND CHOICE – Samsung Galaxy Note 10+

Pros

- highly efficient
- durable
- accessories are available
- stable network
-

Cons

- accessories are quite very expensive (seriously consider)

THIRD CHOICE – Infinix Note 40

Pros

- affordable
- common in the locale
- accessories are available and relatively cheap

Cons

- possible phone lags
- might overheat subsequently
- low durability
- decent battery strength and capacity

FOURTH CHOICE – XIAOMI Redmi 15C

Pros

- affordable
- fairly efficient

Cons

- not common in the locale
- accessories are not easily available
- might overheat subsequently

I'd personally recommend that this would be definitely the last choice. In fact, only if others are not found.

ESTIMATED IMPACT/CONSEQUENCES OF CHOICE

Since the purchase will be offline, i.e., via a physical location or local retail shop, the following I to be considered;

- import fee or retailing fee (N10,000)
- higher prices (as a result of the locale) and lack of discounts (N10,000)

So, adding the expected N20k+, we have;

Phone Brand	Phone Name	Price (N)	New Price (N)
TECNO	Tecno Camon 40 CM5	244,800	264,800
SAMSUNG	Samsung Galaxy Note 10+	264,000	284,000
INFINIX	Infinix Note 40	229,920	249,920
XIAOMI	XIAOMI Redmi 15C	233,899	253,899

CONCLUSION

This project successfully demonstrated how Excel, SQL, and Power BI can be used to transform raw smartphone listings into meaningful insights that support informed purchasing decisions. By analyzing 412 phone listings from Jumia, the project identified 35 smartphone brands and highlighted Samsung, Apple, Tecno, Infinix, and Xiaomi as the five most frequently listed brands. Further analysis focused on smartphones within the ₦300,000–₦450,000 budget range (or below 450k), prioritizing RAM, ROM, affordability, brand availability, and ease of sourcing accessories and spare parts.

Based on the findings, the Tecno Camon 40 CM5 emerged as the first-choice recommendation, offering a balance of affordability, storage capacity, and local availability. The Samsung Galaxy Note 10+ was identified as an alternative for its perceived efficiency and durability, while the Infinix Note 40 and Xiaomi Redmi 15C provided additional options at competitive prices. The analysis also accounted for estimated additional offline purchasing costs, demonstrating the importance of considering the total cost of acquisition rather than online prices alone.

Overall, this project highlights the value of data analytics in solving practical business and consumer problems. It demonstrates the application of data extraction, cleaning, validation, SQL querying, DAX measures, and visualization to produce actionable recommendations. Although prices, stock availability, and product specifications may change, the analytical approach provides a structured framework for comparing alternatives and making evidence-based purchasing decisions.